tomale

BRAND GUIDELINES

SUMMER 2025

Today a reader

tomorrow a leader.

INSIGHT

Since 2005, levels of reading engagement in young people have been quietly collapsing. In 2024 just ⅓ of children report enjoying reading in their free time, instead preferring habit-forming, dopaminergic content provided by video games and online streaming platforms.

This issue is made much worse by deprivation, with children from the poorest UK families 4x more likely to meet the expected reading levels by age 4. Studies show a lack of reading engagement is heavily linked to poor cross-curriculum educational outcomes and increased risk of mental health issues and unemployment.

Tomale.ai is an AI-powered storytelling platform on a mission to build a love of reading in every child. We aim to build both passionate and competent readers by empowering children, families and educators to co-author bespoke, fully-illustrated stories in minutes.

Designed for both home and school environments, Tomale combines AI text and image generation with established educational techniques such as synthetic phonics and reinforcement learning to make reading and creativity deeply personal and joyful. Children don't just read stories, they imagine, author, and own them.



VALUE PROPOSITION

Whether for enjoyment, education, exploring creativity, commemmorating a special memory or dealing with complex emotions, Tomale unlocks the power of storytelling for all.

DEVELOPING CREATIVITY

Children, families and educators can co-author stories using their own characters, using predefined narrative structures and themes. Characters can be used reliably across multiple stories.

EDUCATIONAL IMPACT

Developed with early literacy in mind, Tomale supports reading comprehension, fluency and storytelling skills using principles of synthetic phonics and reinforcement learning.

LASTING MEMORIES

Tomale's bookshelf lets you hold onto the stories that mean the most, a time capsule of a child's imagination, preserved to cherish forever, with hard copies available to order through the store.

EFFORTLESS

Parents and educators can guide story creation in minutes using natural language with our AI assistant, no training or preparation required.

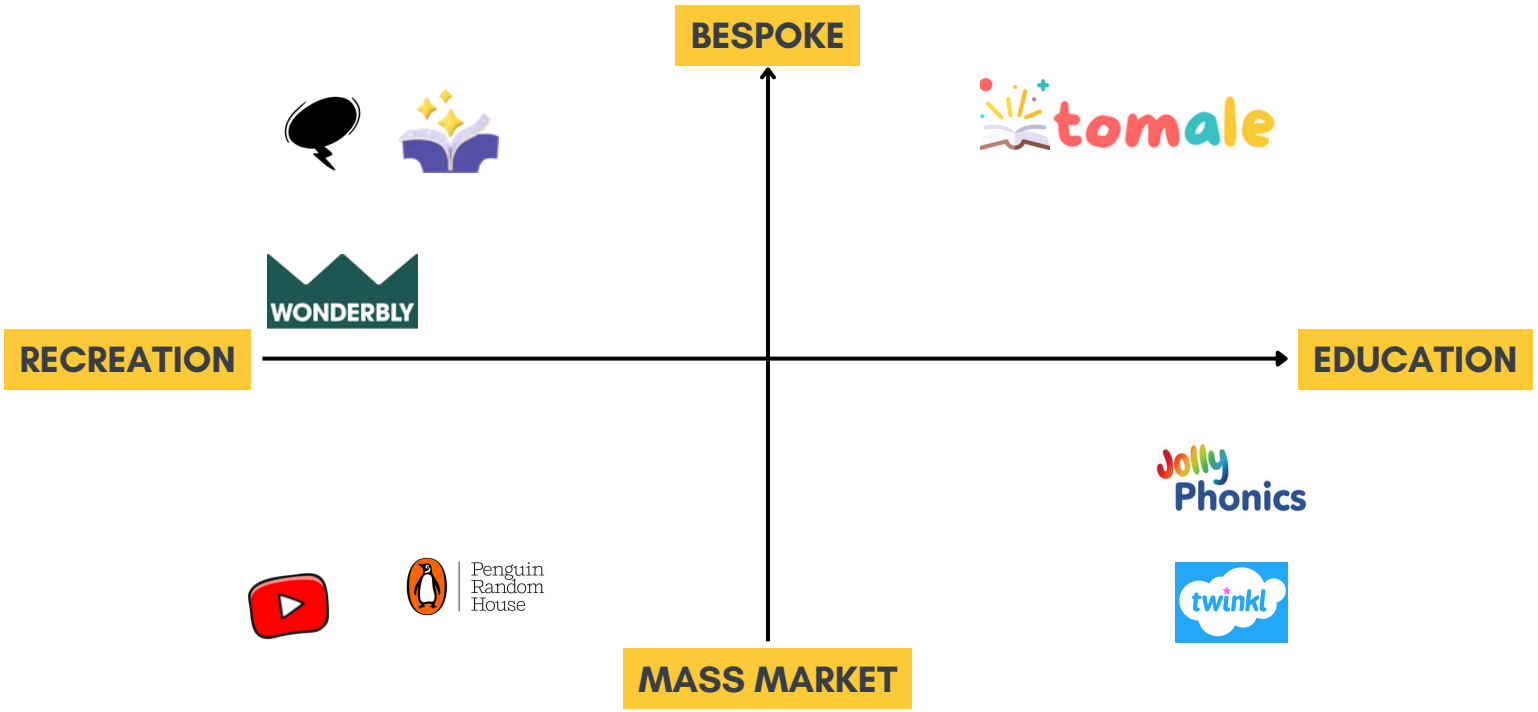
SAFETY FIRST

Strict content moderation, data policies and GDPR compliance prevent harmful content, ensuring children are safe to freely explore powerful AI tools with guardrails.

MINDFUL MEDIA

Unlike much of the media our children consume today, Tomale encourages collaboration and connection, turning screen time into something more valuable.

COMPETITIVE LANDSCAPE



COMPETITOR	SEGMENT
STORYSPARK.AI STORYTIME.AI	AI STORYTELLING & CREATION
WONDERBLY MYMAGICSTORY	CUSTOMISABLE PRINTED BOOKS
TWINKL JOLLY PHONICS	PHONICS SOFTWARE
PENGUIN	TRADITIONAL PUBLISHING
NETFLIX KIDS YOUTUBE KIDS	KIDS ENTERTAINMENT

COMPETITIVE LANDSCAPE

COMPETITOR	DIFFERENTIATION
STORYSPARK.AI STORYTIME.AI	DECODABLE STORIES MULTIPLE ART STYLES STORY SERIALISATION BESPOKE CHARACTERS
WONDERBLY MYMAGICSTORY	PRICING BESPOKE STORIES CUSTOM CHARACTERS BOTH PRINT & DIGITAL
TWINKL JOLLY PHONICS	AI NATIVE CHILD-LED HIGH PRINT QUALITY
PENGUIN	BESPOKE STORIES EDUCATION FOCUSED
NETFLIX KIDS YOUTUBE KIDS	GUILT-FREE SCREEN TIME PHYSICAL MEDIA

IDEAL CUSTOMER PROFILES

PARENTS OF 0-3 YEAR OLDS

PAIN POINTS: GUILT OVER SCREEN TIME, LIMITED TIME OR ENERGY FOR STRUCTURED READING, DIFFICULTY FINDING CALMING AND AGE-APPROPRIATE CONTENT

HABITS & CONTEXT: OFTEN ON PARENTAL LEAVE OR WORKING PART-TIME; ROUTINES CENTRED AROUND NAPS, FEEDING, AND SETTLING. HIGH USE OF INSTAGRAM, YOUTUBE AND FACEBOOK PARENTING GROUPS.

PSYCHOGRAPHICS: SEEK EMOTIONAL CONNECTION, CALMING TECH, AND REASSURANCE THEY'RE DOING WHAT'S BEST FOR THEIR CHILD'S DEVELOPMENT VOICE OF CUSTOMER: "I WANT TO FEEL LIKE I'M DOING THE RIGHT THING WHEN I HAND THEM MY PHONE."

BEST CHANNELS TO REACH: INSTAGRAM REELS, PARENTING PODCASTS, FACEBOOK GROUPS

JTBD STATEMENT: WHEN I NEED QUIET TIME WITH MY TODDLER BUT I'M EXHAUSTED, I WANT CONTENT THAT FEELS MEANINGFUL AND CALM, SO I CAN FEEL LIKE A GREAT PARENT WITHOUT EXTRA EFFORT.

HIGH ENGAGEMENT SUBGROUPS: PARENTS OF PREMATURE BABIES; PARENTS FOCUSED ON SCREEN-FREE EARLY YEARS DEVELOPMENT; FIRST-TIME PARENTS ACTIVELY SEEKING GUILT-FREE TECH ALTERNATIVES

IDEAL CUSTOMER PROFILES

PARENTS OF 3-7 YEAR OLDS

PAIN POINTS: STRUGGLE TO MANAGE SCREEN TIME, DIFFICULTY BUILDING CONSISTENT READING HABITS, WANT EDUCATIONAL CONTENT THAT'S ALSO FUN

HABITS & CONTEXT: FREQUENTLY MULTITASKING; OFTEN READING AT BEDTIME OR AFTER SCHOOL. HIGH INSTAGRAM AND PINTEREST USE. RESEARCH APPS OR BOOKS RECOMMENDED BY FRIENDS AND INFLUENCERS.

PSYCHOGRAPHICS: WANT TO NURTURE CREATIVITY AND SUPPORT THEIR CHILD'S DEVELOPMENT WHILE KEEPING THEM ENGAGED

VOICE OF CUSTOMER: "WE'RE TRYING TO REPLACE COCOMELON WITH SOMETHING BETTER — AND IT HAS TO HOLD THEIR ATTENTION."

BEST CHANNELS TO REACH: INSTAGRAM REELS, PARENTING BLOGS

JTBD STATEMENT: WHEN I WANT TO HELP MY CHILD WIND DOWN AFTER SCHOOL, I WANT A FUN AND CREATIVE STORY ACTIVITY, SO WE CAN SPEND TIME TOGETHER WITHOUT STRESS.

HIGH-ENGAGEMENT SUBGROUPS: PARENTS OF CHILDREN WITH DYSLEXIA OR SPEECH DELAYS; HOME EDUCATORS; PARENTS PURCHASING GIFTS FOR BIRTHDAYS OR HOLIDAYS

IDEAL CUSTOMER PROFILES

EYFS & KS1 TEACHERS

PAIN POINTS: LOW-AI PROFICIENCY, BUDGET CONSTRAINTS, STRUGGLE TO ENGAGE RELUCTANT READERS, MIXED ABILITIES IN CLASS, LIMITED PREP TIME AND RESOURCES

HABITS & CONTEXT: OFTEN UNDER TIME PRESSURE. RESPONSIVE TO CPD OR PRACTICAL TOOLS THAT SAVE TIME. ENGAGED IN FACEBOOK GROUPS AND TWINKL, SCAN LINKEDIN FOR EDTECH TRENDS.

PSYCHOGRAPHICS: PASSIONATE ABOUT LITERACY, WARY OF UNPROVEN TECH, SEEK TOOLS THAT ARE INTUITIVE AND CLASSROOM-ALIGNED

VOICE OF CUSTOMER: "I LOVE NEW IDEAS — BUT IT HAS TO FIT INTO MY DAY AND MY CURRICULUM."

BEST CHANNELS TO REACH: LINKEDIN, TEACHING RESOURCE NEWSLETTERS, CPD WEBINARS

JTBD STATEMENT: WHEN I WANT TO MOTIVATE MY PUPILS TO WRITE OR READ INDEPENDENTLY, I WANT A LOW-PREP TOOL THAT SPARKS CREATIVITY, SO MY CLASSROOM STAYS CALM AND ENGAGED.

HIGH-ENGAGEMENT SUBGROUPS: LITERACY COORDINATORS; NQTS LOOKING TO MODERNISE; PRIVATE SCHOOLS.

IDEAL CUSTOMER PROFILES

NURSERY EDUCATORS & MANAGERS

PAIN POINTS: NEED SIMPLE LITERACY ACTIVITIES THAT ALIGN TO EYFS OUTCOMES, WANT TO DEMONSTRATE IMPACT TO PARENTS, STRUGGLE WITH RESOURCING

HABITS & CONTEXT: ENGAGE IN CPD-FOCUSED EVENTS, RELY ON WORD-OF-MOUTH, OFTEN IN FACEBOOK GROUPS OR LOCAL AUTHORITY COMMS. PRIORITISE EASE AND SAFETY IN NEW TOOLS.

PSYCHOGRAPHICS: VALUE PARENT TRUST, CRAVE SIMPLICITY, OPEN TO DIGITAL IF IT FEELS DEVELOPMENTALLY APPROPRIATE

VOICE OF CUSTOMER: "WE DON'T HAVE TIME TO LEARN NEW SOFTWARE — IT HAS TO BE PLUG-AND-PLAY."

BEST CHANNELS TO REACH: EARLY YEARS CPD NETWORKS, FACEBOOK GROUPS, LOCAL AUTHORITY PARTNERSHIPS

JTBD STATEMENT: WHEN I NEED A LITERACY ACTIVITY FOR TOMORROW'S SESSION, I WANT SOMETHING CHILDREN CAN HELP SHAPE AND TAKE HOME, SO I CAN MEET EYFS GOALS AND ENGAGE FAMILIES.

HIGH-ENGAGEMENT SUBGROUPS: MONTESSORI / CHILD-LED SETTINGS; SETTINGS FOCUSED ON LANGUAGE-RICH ENVIRONMENTS; NURSERIES WITH LITERACY GRANTS

IDEAL CUSTOMER PROFILES

EARLY YEARS ADVOCACY / AFFILIATES

PAIN POINTS: NEED TO INCREASE REACH, MAY WANT TO RECOMMEND EDUCATIONAL SOFTWARE AND TOOLS, CONCERNED ABOUT AI SAFETY AND CREDIBILITY

HABITS & CONTEXT: REGULARLY ATTEND LOCAL AUTHORITY / NON-PROFIT EVENTS, POTENTIALLY INTERESTED IN SPEAKING ENGAGEMENTS, ENGAGED IN CONTENT CREATION & LOBBYING/INFLUENCING ACTIVITIES AT GOV'T LEVEL.

PSYCHOGRAPHICS: DEEP PASSION ABOUT SUBJECT MATTER, RESERVED ABOUT NEW ENTRANTS, SUSPICIOUS OF TRANSACTIONAL RELATIONSHIPS.

VOICE OF CUSTOMER: "WE DON'T HAVE TIME TO LEARN NEW SOFTWARE — IT HAS TO BE PLUG-AND-PLAY."

BEST CHANNELS TO REACH: EARLY YEARS CPD NETWORKS, FACEBOOK GROUPS, LOCAL AUTHORITY PARTNERSHIPS

JTBD STATEMENT: WHEN I NEED A LITERACY ACTIVITY FOR TOMORROW'S SESSION, I WANT SOMETHING CHILDREN CAN HELP SHAPE AND TAKE HOME, SO I CAN MEET EYFS GOALS AND ENGAGE FAMILIES.

HIGH-ENGAGEMENT SUBGROUPS: MANAGERS OF NURSERIES OFFERING PRINTED KEEPSAKES TO PARENTS; SETTINGS FOCUSED ON LANGUAGE-RICH ENVIRONMENTS; NURSERIES WITH LITERACY GRANTS

BRAND GUIDELINES & VOICE

LOGOS



PRIMARY
(LIGHT BACKGROUND)



PRIMARY
(DARK BACKGROUND)



APP ICON



COMBINED



TEXT ONLY

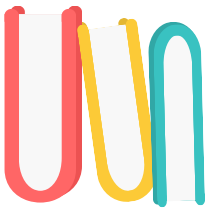
COLOR PALETTE

HERO	CORAL	MINT	SUNFLOWER	GREY	BROWN
LINEAR 90' #FF3131 : #FF914D	#FF6666	#39C2C1	#39C2C1	#F8F8F8	#A6A26A

ICONS



CREATE



BOOKSHELF



LIBRARY



STORE

BRAND GUIDELINES & VOICE

FONTS & TYPOGRAPHY

APP FONTS

Logo

More Sugar

Text

Glacial Indifference

HEADING SIZE 32

The body text in documents should be size 14.

TAGLINES

MISSION

To build a love of reading in every child

TAGLINE

Today a reader tomorrow a leader.

BRAND GUIDELINES & VOICE

MESSAGING

CREATIVITY & IMAGINATION

Stories are co-authored by children, families and caregivers, building a sense of choice and ownership from an early age.

EDUCATIONAL OUTCOMES

Grounded in established educational techniques such as synthetic phonics and reinforcement learning

EMOTIONAL CONNECTION

Create deeply personal stories that aren't available anywhere else. Focus on the power of storytelling in exploring creativity, making memories and dealing with life's challenges.

MINDFUL MEDIA

Turn screen time into something positive and relaxing that develops attention and focus instead of breaking it.

EASE & SAFETY

Bringing the power of AI tools with a child-friendly, engaging design, along with reassuring content & data safeguards.

TONE

ASPIRATIONAL & POSITIVE

Focused on the burgeoning potential within every child, using language to reinforce the power of stories for confidence building and creativity.

WARM & WHOLESOME

Like a favourite bedtime story, stick to calming, inclusive and non-inflammatory language.

IMAGINATIVE & PLAYFUL

Never silly or condescending. Encourage curiosity and exploration without overly dumbing down. Treat users as capable creators.

EDUCATIONAL AND CLEAR

In marketing and during onboarding, explain concepts in simple, plain language. In storytelling, focus on specified age ranges and difficulty levels to meet, and later exceed expected reading levels through gentle exposure to new words and concepts.

YES

- Maintain positivity
- Building love of reading, not just competence.
- Emphasise value through choice and a sense of ownership
- Emphasise the value of bespoke content
- Prioritise emotional over functional benefits

NO

- Technical jargon
- Overplaying 'coolness' of AI. Too gimmicky.
- Accusatory statements around parenting
- Blaming teachers or education

